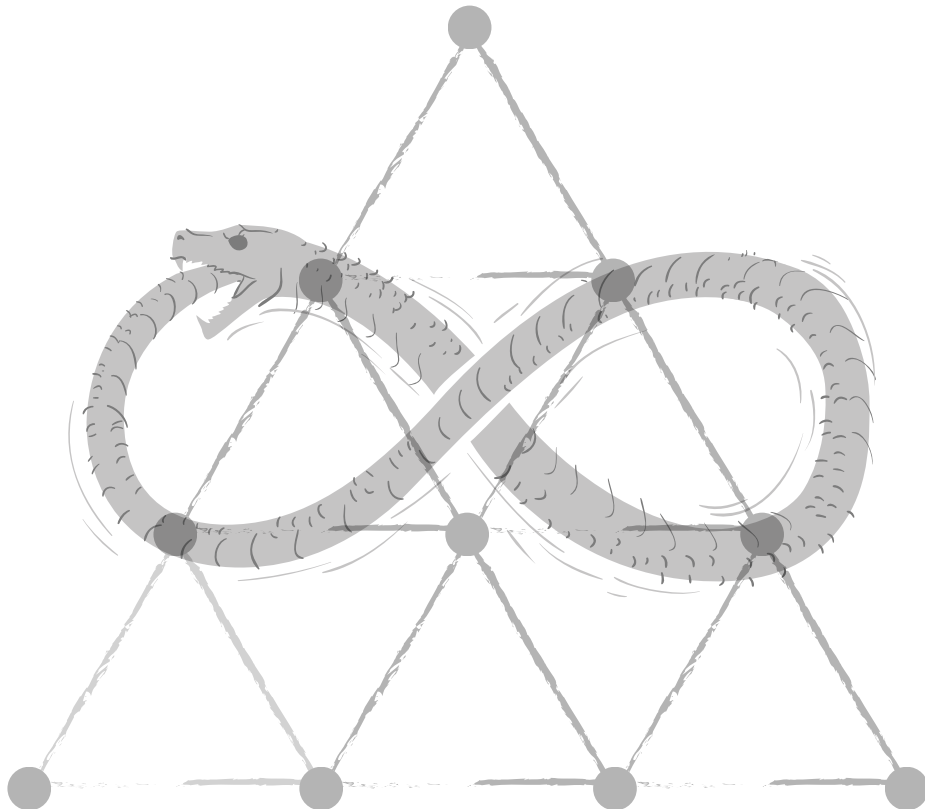


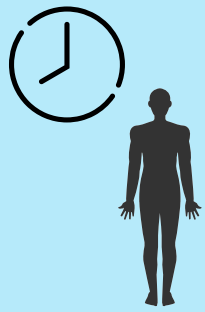
THE TAROT MYSTICISM PROCESS

By Joe Monteleone



3 PLANES OF TAROT

Level 1: Mechanical



The body/mechanical plane of tarot practice focuses on what a person's body will be doing, where, with who, and when. It is oftentimes predictive. It answers questions like, "When will I get married? What is my next job? Will my health improve?" The general mode of questioning is, "What will happen to me?" These types of readings focus on detail and can be very impressive to answer. Many clients expect something like this from tarot at first.

Personal

- "Mechanical" means it looks at what is knocking into what to make the physical circumstances
- Includes predictive readings
- Oftentimes, concerns action, physical events and the body
- Mode of questioning: "What will happen to me?"

Level 2: Subtle/Causal



This level of tarot reading gives information on what is causing the results that materialize around us. Here, the cards show us patterns in our life, whether that's energetic, karmic, psychological or otherwise. It answers questions like, "who am I?" This is the backstage of our reality, the subtle plane, and the realm of symbol and archetype. Many tarot readers are familiar with this level of work, and it has become more popular over recent decades.

Personal Relating to Transpersonal

- This level is "subtle" or "causal" because it shows what is causing the physical circumstances to show up
- This can be viewed as a psychological or energetic layer.
- Mode of questioning: "Who am I?"

Level 3: Mystical

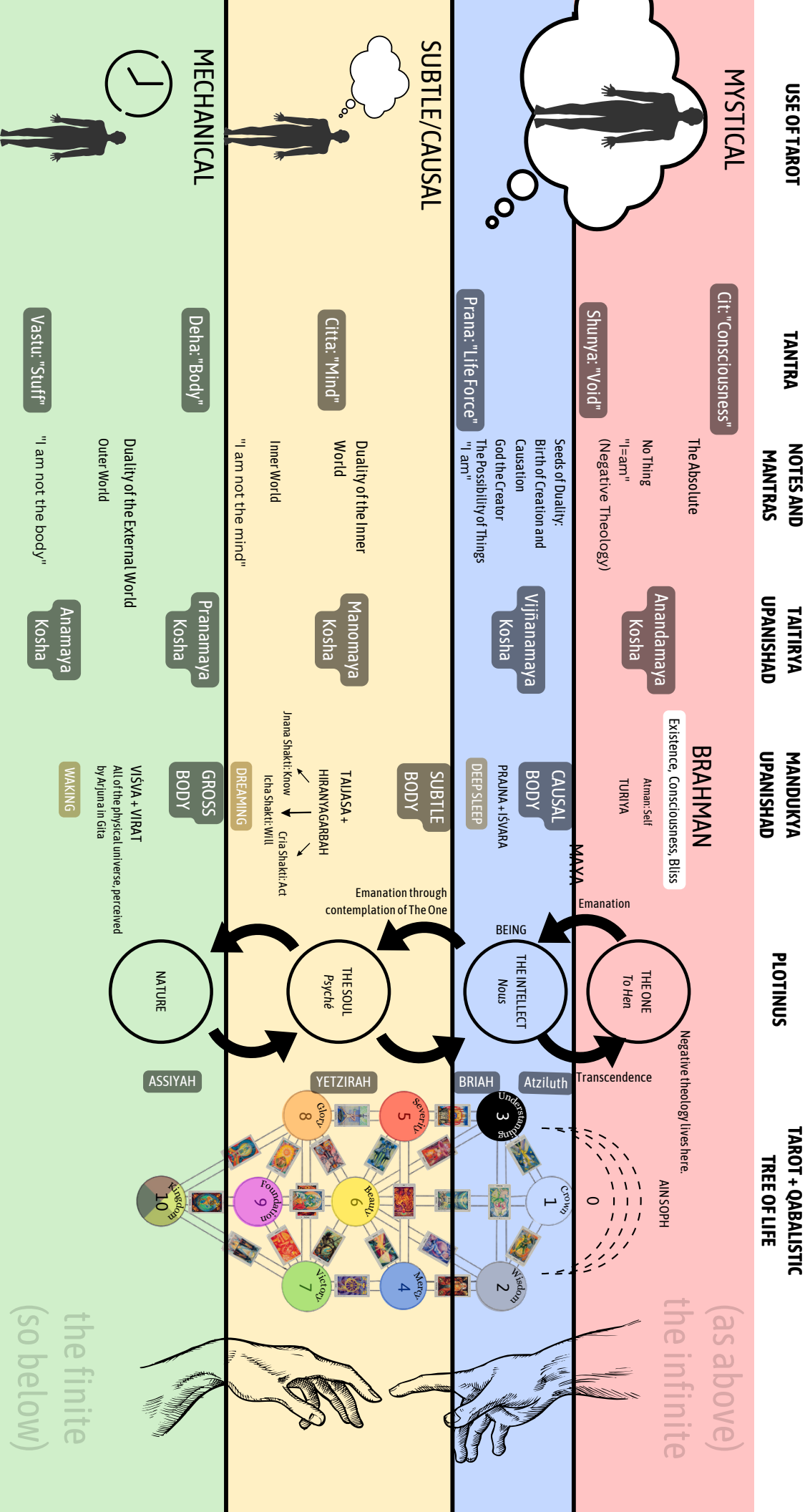


The highest level of tarot reading isn't so much reading as it is direct knowledge. At this level, we stop asking "who am I?" and start asking "what am I?" The tarot becomes a holographic system of mystical insight that leads to the highest revelations and the deepest peace. It is holographic because, at this level, every symbol starts expressing the whole system, just as you, the seeker, start to express the whole universe. It is mystical because, at this level, the tarot starts to point to an apprehension of absolute unity. This is less commonly understood than the first two.

Transpersonal

- This level is concerned with mysteries that transcend the individual.
- Mode of questioning: "What am I?"

... COME OUT OF NOTHING?



TAROT DIVINATION IS ABOUT THINGS

Divination is about becoming aware of "**THINGS**" (which, for our purposes, include people and places).

THINGS are done, made, different, or changeable.
They are "here or there", and "coming or going" and
always arise in consciousness.

Consciousness is not done, made, different, or
changeable. It is both "here and there" and neither
"coming" nor "going". It simply is.



OH LOOK!
"THINGS" BEING DONE,
MADE, DIFFERENT, OR
CHANGEABLE.

MORE ON "THINGS"

In tarot divination, we identify with some "THING": anything done, made, different, or changeable, in time or space, here or there, coming or going.

Doing, making, differentiating and changing often happen simultaneously. From a mystical perspective, they are all the same thing. From a divinatory/manifestation perspective, they are different.

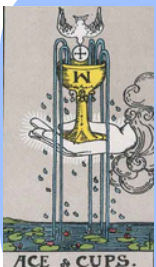


DOING

When you do something, you happen to the world.

Element: Fire

Example: doing your job, "doing your thing", doing good, doing bad, "just do it!"



MAKING

When you make something, you combine parts of reality into a new form.

Element: Water

Example: making love, making art, making people happy, "making a fuss"



DIFFERENTIATING

When you differentiate, you *make* one thing different from another thing, like a sword cleaving something in two.

Element: Air

Example: "I am not like those people, but I am like these people". "I'm different."



CHANGING

When you change something, you turn one combination of reality into another.

Element: Earth

Example: changing time and effort into money (working a job), growth, seasons

IF TAROT DIVINATION IS ABOUT "THINGS" TAROT MYSTICISM IS ABOUT "NO THING"

In Tarot Mysticism, there is no THING after the I. There just IS. Tarot Mysticism is the art of affirming real existence without conditions. It is simply being.

I AM ...

If it's not about a THING ...

It's about NO THING.

TAROT DIVINATION AND "THINGS":



DOING

"I am doing my job."



MAKING

"I am making love."



DIFFERENTIATING

"I am different than those people."



CHANGING

"I am changing my life."

TAROT MYSTICISM AND "NO THING":

BEING

"I am."

BEING

"I am."

BEING

"I am."

BEING

"I am."

BUT ...

I AM ... WHAT?

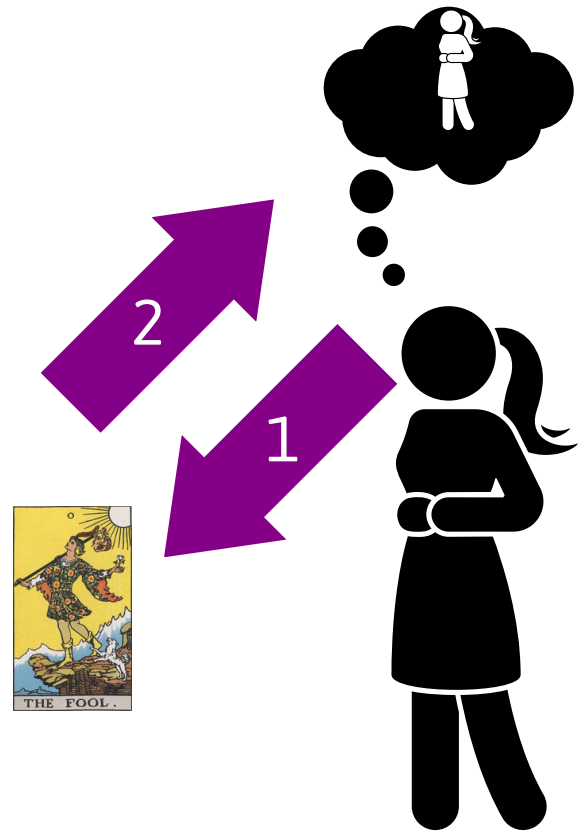
I AM THAT I AM



The Tarot Reading Process

Reading for Yourself:

A subject (reader) becomes aware of **"THINGS"** (divination) within itself (reader) through symbolic medium (cards). **"THINGS" are anything done, made, different, or changeable, here or there, coming or going.**



Reading for Others:

A subject (reader) becomes aware of **"THINGS"** (divination) within another subject (querent) through symbolic medium (cards).



The Tarot Mysticism Process

Instead of using the cards to become aware of a "Thing" (something the questioner might do, make, differentiate, or change, here or there, coming or going), it becomes aware of its own being *directly*.

In this approach, the questioner does not look for an idea of itself in the future or past, but approaches itself *directly*.

The self beholding itself creates a paradox and infinite loop (an ouroboros). The tarot, especially the major arcana, is an expression of this infinite loop. It shows how the universe becomes you through knowing itself (manifestation). The other side of this loop is you recognizing you are the universe (mysticism). This infinite loop one of the most sought after secrets of so many mystics, philosophers, and sages.

When we identify with "THINGS" (what we do, make, differentiate, or change, here or there, coming or going), we manifest or divine. When we remove our identifications with "THINGS", we are doing mysticism (eg. "I am not my body, I am not my mind").

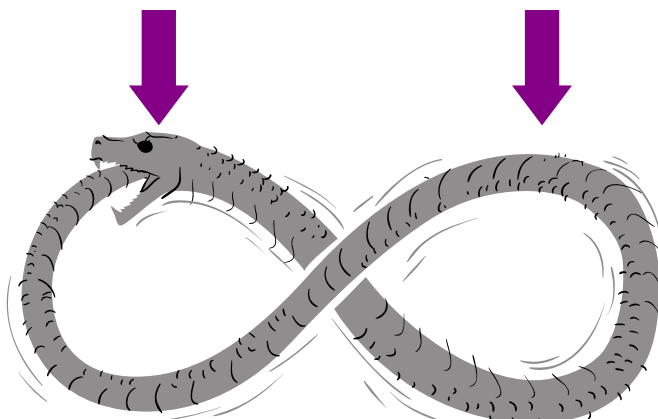
Manifestation and divination lead to "THINGS".

Mysticism leads to divine "NO THING".



MANIFESTATION/DIVINATION

MYSTICISM



EXAMPLES OF "NO THING" IN VARIOUS TRADITIONS

If Everything is that from which
nothing can be removed or added
And Nothing is that from which
nothing can be removed or added
Then everything IS nothing
(Hegel)

If there is one thing I know ... it is nothing.

"Oh Nuit, continuous one
of Heaven, let it be ever
thus; that men speak not
of Thee as One but as
None; and let them
speak not of thee at all,
since thou art
continuous!"
--Book of the Law

Nirviculpa Samadhi

Nirguna Brahman

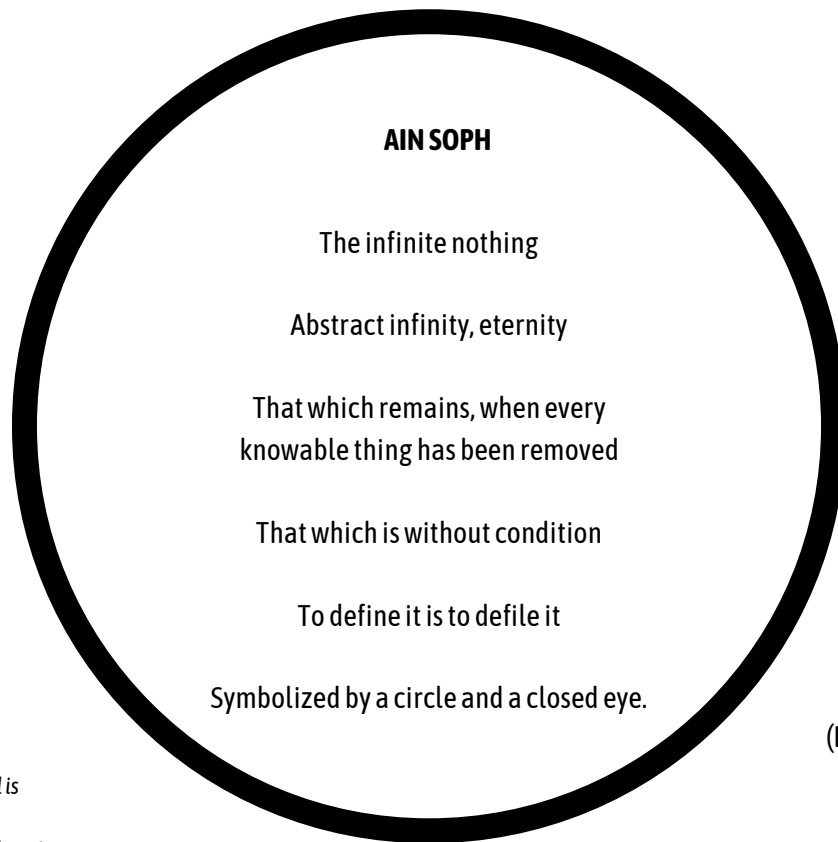
"The All"
--The Kybalion

*Ten Sephiroth of Nothingness: Their end is
imbedded in their beginning, and their
beginning in their end, like a flame in a burning
coal. For the Master is singular, He has no
second. And before One, what do you count?*
(Sepher Yetzirah 1:7)

"Neti Neti"
--Bṛhadaranyaka Upanishad

"God: an infinite sphere whose centre is
everywhere and whose circumference is nowhere"
--Book of 24 Philosophers

"Nothingness which twinkles... but what twinkles!"
--Aleister Crowley



Beli-mah
(Hebrew for "without anything")

"Sunyata" (Zen)

Mūlamadhyamakakārikā of
Nagarjuna

TAROT MYSTICISM IS ABOUT "NO THING"

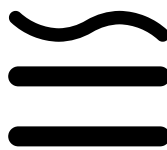


"NO THING" can be expressed in an apophatic way, through negation. In this mode, mystics point out the ultimate reality by discerning what it is not. Some examples of this include:

- *Sunyata*, the doctrine of the void/emptiness as seen in the Zen or Mulamadhyamaka tradition of Buddhism (See the *Mulamadhyamakakarika* by Nagarjuna)
- *Neti Neti*, "not that, not that", (*Brihadaranyaka Upanishad* 2.3. 6)
- Pseudo-Dionysius the Areopagite, a Christian Neoplatonist
- Ain Soph of the Kabbalah (Jewish mysticism)



"NO THING" can be expressed in a cataphatic way, through **RADICAL ONTOLOGICAL AFFIRMATION**. In this mode, the mystic attempts to point at the ultimate reality, instead of describing what it is NOT. ***But the ultimate reality includes all things. How does one point at something that includes the one pointing?*** This very paradox has inspired the most profound writings of mystics, sages, and philosophers, from the Upanishads to the Enneads and now tarot. The next page includes the ***mahavakyas and other ontological affirmations (or "mystical mic-drops")***. They are affirmations of the absolute.



Ontological Affirmations, Mahavakyas and other Slightly Isomorphic Mystical Mic-Drops



Tatvamasi (Thou Art That)
-Chandogya Upanishad

Aham brahmasmi (I am Brahman)
--Brihadaranyaka Upanishad

Ehieh Asher Ehieh (I am that I am)
--Exodus

Prajnana is Brahman. (Wisdom is the Self)
-The Aitareya Upanishad

Ayam Atma Brahma (This Self is Brahman)
-The Mandukya Upanishad

Tathata ("thatness/suchness" of Buddhism)

Come now, I will tell thee . . . the only two ways of search that can be thought of. The first, namely, that It is, and that it is impossible for anything not to be, is the way of conviction, for truth is its companion.

-Parmenides, On Nature

Nothing real can be threatened. Nothing unreal exists. Herein lies the peace of God.

-A Course in Miracles

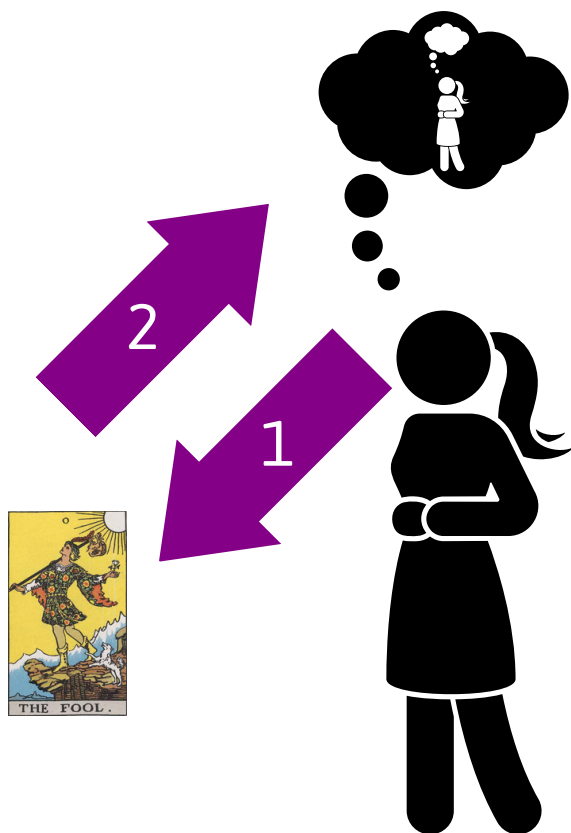
Ana al-Haqq (I am the Truth)
-Mansur al-Hallaj

I, oh Arguna! am that which is and that which is not.

--Bhagavad Gita

This All is universal power, of infinite extent and infinite in potency, a god so great that all his parts are infinite. Name any place, and he is already there.

— Plotinus



These ontological affirmations, *mahavakyas*, and mystical mic-drops are expressions of Self-Knowledge. Self-knowledge is a paradox. How can a self know itself without being something other than itself?

In 2 ways:

1) By becoming a "THING" other than itself (Manifestation)

2) By un-becoming a "THING" and returning to itself as "NO THING" (Mysticism).

In Tarot Divination, a self knows itself by looking into its own creation or idea of itself. Tarot Divination looks at "THINGS": things are done, made, different, changeable, here or there, coming or going, in time or space.

This can easily be communicated verbally, because **LANGUAGE is LINEAR**. It leads one "THING" to different "THING".

In Tarot Mysticism, the Self knows itself directly. There is "NO THING" outside of that which observes it. This is gnosis.

*This cannot be communicated verbally, because **LANGUAGE is LINEAR**. When there is "NO THING", there is nothing for a line to lead to, and no line can be made for linear language.*



"THIS IS WHERE I DRAW THE LINE!"

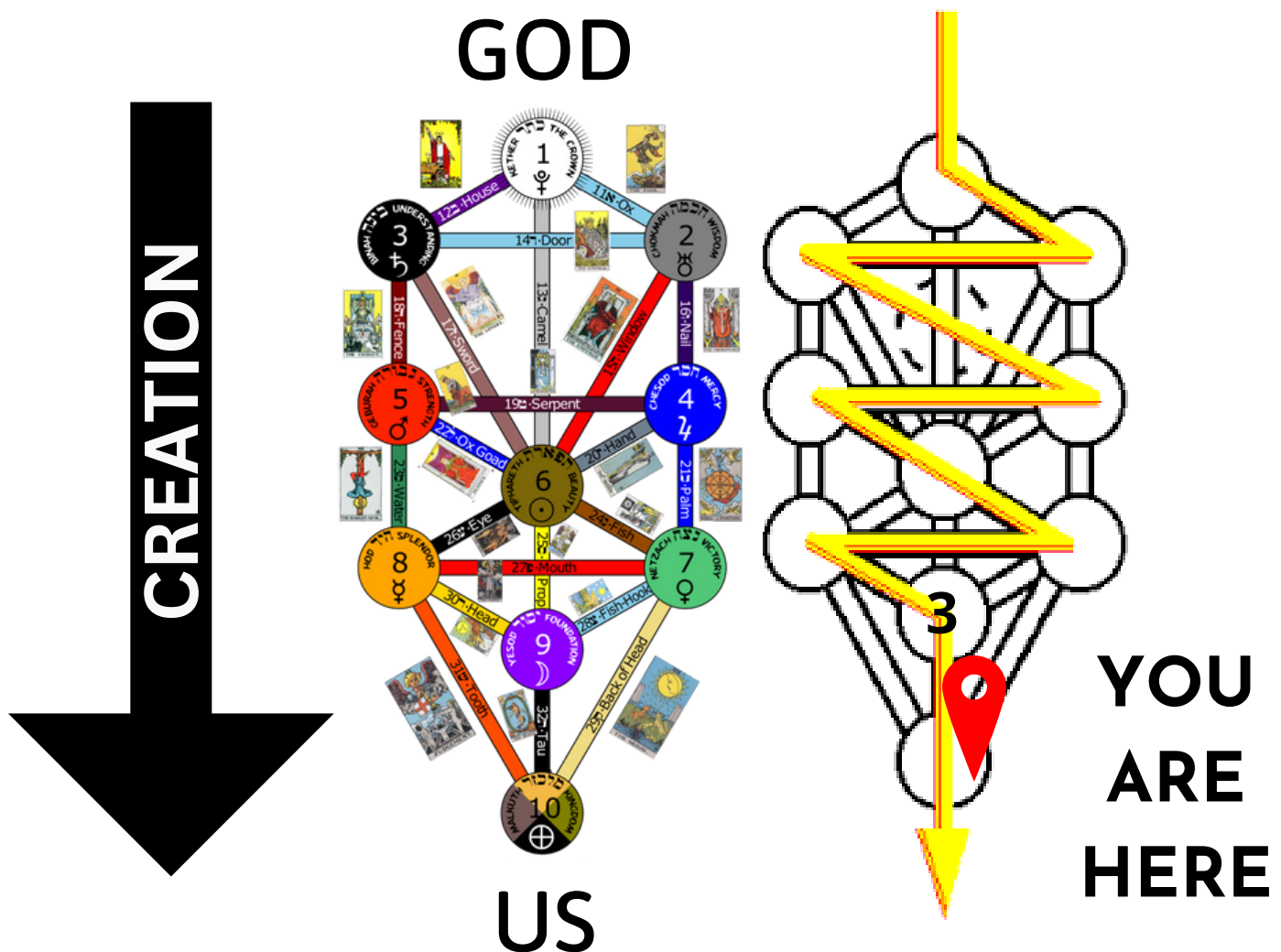
DUALITY AND THE TREE OF LIFE

Since language is linear, it always draws a line from one **"THING"** to another **"THING"** (something done, made, different, or changeable, here or there, coming or going). This makes language dual.

Mystics have attempted to express ineffable unity through **LINEAR** language, **DUALITY**. The Kabbalists literally drew lines from unity/God to duality/our world when they invented the Tree of Life.

The tarot perfectly expresses the Tree of Life. They both detail the cosmic process of creation.

It shows how God does, makes, differentiates, and changes, how God does its **"THING"**!

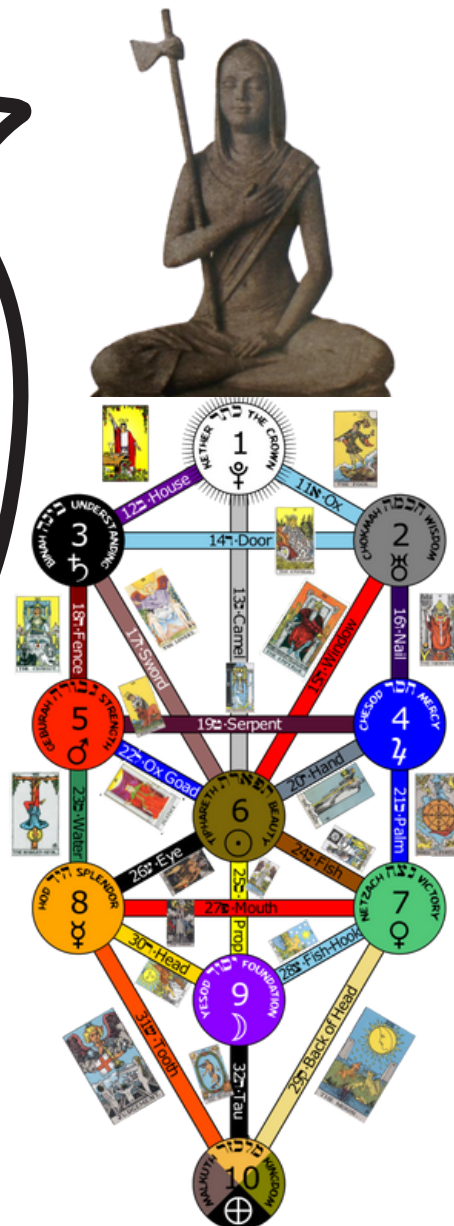


CROSSING THE LINE

NON DUALITY

However, from the top of the tree of life, at the peak of spiritual awareness, the sages, mystics, and philosophers can only speak in contradictions. At that level, there is "NO THING". **There is "NO THING" done, made, different, or changable, here or there, coming or going.** There is **NO DUALITY**.

ALL THIS DUALITY THAT IS
NOTHING BUT MAYA, IS BUT
NON-DUALITY IN REALITY.
--GAUDAPADA, MANDUKYA
KARIKA 1.18



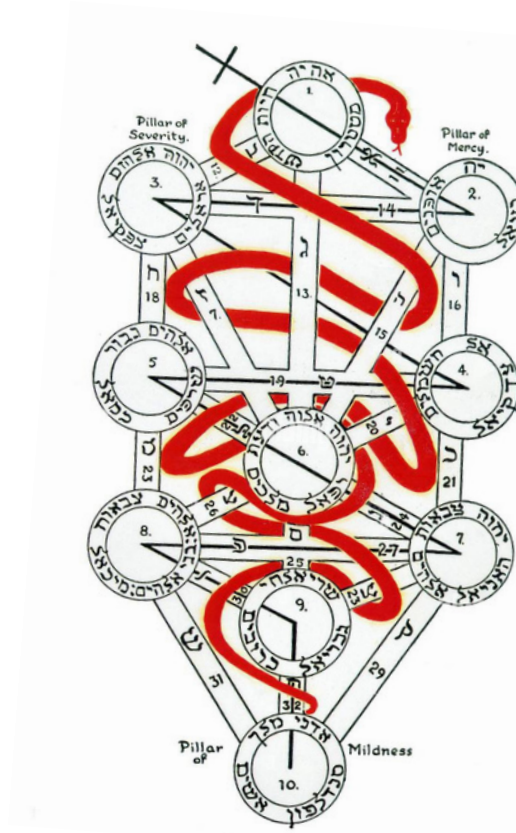
In the Hermetic tradition, this non duality is expressed in
the following excerpt of the Corpus Hermeticum (Book 17 in
John Everard's translation):

3. All things that appear, were made, and are made.
4. Those things that are made, are not made by themselves, but by another.
5. And there are many things made, but especially all things that appear, and which are different, and not like.
6. If the things that be made and done, be made and done by another, there must be one that must make, and do them; and he unmade, and more ancient than the things that are made.
7. For I affirm the things that are made, to be made by another; and it is impossible, that of the things that are made any should be more ancient than all, but only that which is not made.
8. He is stronger, and One, and only knowing all things indeed, as not having any thing more ancient than himself.
10. Moreover, the things that are made, are visible, but he is invisible; and for this cause, he maketh them, that he may be visible; and therefore he makes them always.
16. Wherefore, letting go all much and vain talking, we must understand these two things, That Which is Made, and Him Which is the Maker; for there is nothing in the middle, between these Two, nor is there any third.
18. For All things, are but two Things, That which Maketh, and that which is Made, and the One of them cannot depart, or be divided from the Other.
19. For neither is it possible that the maker should be without the thing made, for either of them is the self-same thing; therefore cannot the One of them be separated from the other, no more than a thing can be separated from itself.
20. For if he that makes be nothing else, but that which makes alone, Simple, Uncompounded, it is of necessity, that he makes the same thing to himself, to whom it is the Generation of him that maketh to be also All that is made.
21. For that which is generated or made, must necessarily be generated or made by another, but without the Maker that which is made, neither is made, nor is; for the one of them without the other, hath lost his proper Nature by the privation of the other.
22. So if these Two be confessed, That which maketh, and that which is made, then they are One in Union, this going before, and that following.
23. And that which goeth before, is, God the Maker, and that which follows is, that which is made, be it what it will.
24. And let no man be afraid because of the variety of things that are made or done, lest he should cast an aspersion of baseness, or infamy upon God, for it is the only Glory of him to do, or make All things.
25. And this making, or facture is as it were the Body of God, and to him that maketh or doth, there is nothing evil, or filthy to be imputed, or There is Nothing thought Evil or Filthy.
26. For these are Passions that follow Generation as Rust doth Copper, or as Excrements do the Body.
27. But neither did the Copper-smith make the Rust, nor the Maker the Filth, nor God the Evilness.
30. For men that think so, suffer that which is most ridiculous of all; for professing to bless and praise God yet in not ascribing to him the making or doing of All things, they know him not.
31. And besides their not knowing him, they are extremely impious against him, attributing unto him Passions, as Pride, or Oversight, or Weakness, or Ignorance, or Envy.

TLDR:

There is no separation from
"made" and "maker"

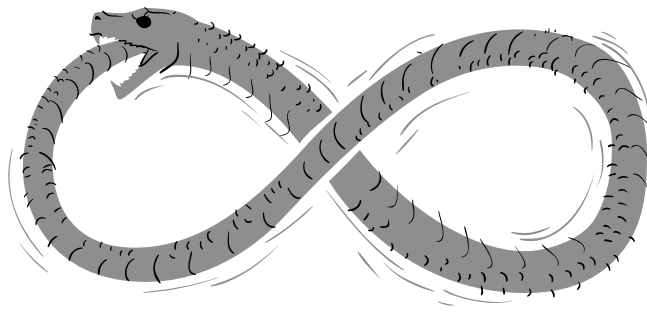
MAKER



NOTE: The dyad is called "tolma" by Plotinus, a word that can describe the motive for differentiation and the soul's decent. The biggest mystery, how some "thing" (duality) comes out of "No thing" (unity) can be conceptualized as a nerve of the universe to "be". The irony is that there is no "thing" to be but itself. In the 17th and last book of the Corpus Hermeticum, Hermes gives his final teaching on this very topic: the unity of the made with the maker. At this level, there is no separation.

MADE

This lack of separation is (partially)
symbolized by the ouroboros.



MAKER



"NO THING"

MYSTICISM

MANIFESTATION/
DIVINATION

"THINGS"

MADE

THE TAROT MYSTICISM PROCESS

The Tarot Mysticism Process uses the cards to help understand this **"NO THING"** or non duality.

Each tarot card and its corresponding path on the tree of life (among other attributions) is used as a radical ontological affirmation similar to the great sayings and isomorphic "mystical mic-drops" of various mystical traditions.

Each card, and path, connects two sephirot. These sephirot have contemporary titles. The new titles help the student bridge one experience with another. This connects every level of experience with every other level to reach the top.

After enough contemplation, the separation between levels of experience (in this case, sephirot) will dissolve. This achieves a non dual understanding that cannot be put into words. It creates the conditions for a mystical experience.

These are NOT personal affirmations where you identify with an aspect of you (eg. "I am powerful", "I am strong", "I am healthy"). These are existential affirmations of your full being, various forms of "I am."

All of the majors together create a bridge from the absolute to your current experience as "you".

The most effective mode of this practice is "I am." This takes the form "IS".

However, if that feels too abstract, you can use "CREATES" or "BECOMES", which would make the process dualistic.

The Holographic Tree of Life for Ontological Affirmation

Each PART contains the pattern of the WHOLE.

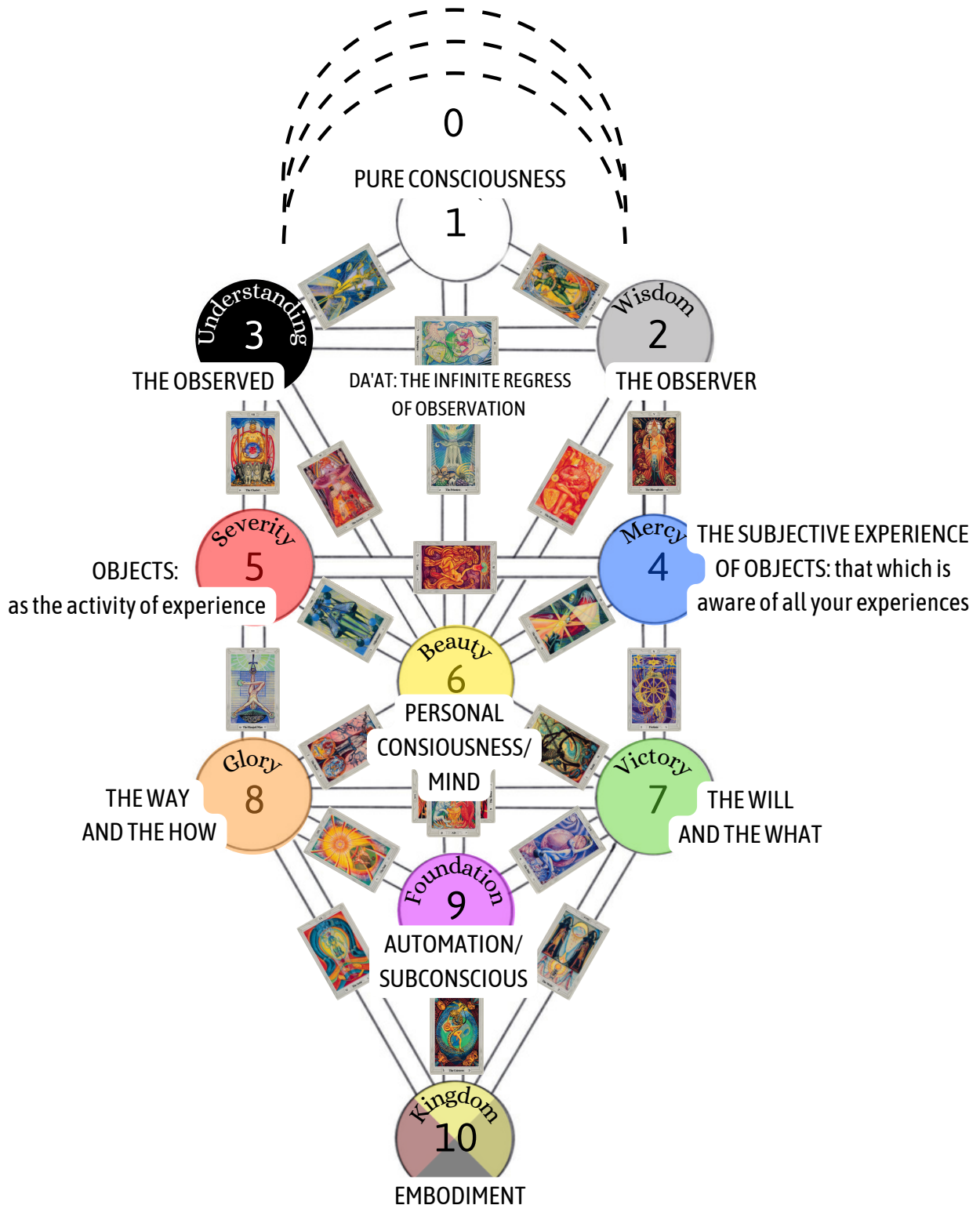
Each PART and the WHOLE IS "BEING".

Each PART and the WHOLE expresses these great ontological affirmations.

I AM

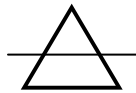
THAT

I AM



PURE CONSCIOUSNESS PM

Crown
1



Wisdom
2



The fool IS pure consciousness in search of experience. In becoming Self-aware, it "becomes" the observer. This sets off a series of mutually arising revelations illustrated in the 21 major arcana cards that follow. The fool is complete, but perhaps without knowledge. The following cards represent expressions of the fool (and us) that lead to the knowledge of completeness and our divine nature. Each card expresses the same mystery in a different way. By contemplating each card, we gain further insight into the mystery of the fool to resolve the paradox of self-knowledge.

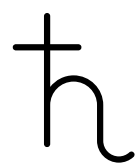
AM THE OBSERVER

PURE CONSCIOUSNESS PM

Crown
1



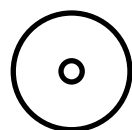
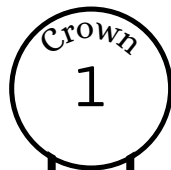
Understanding
3



Pure consciousness is observed by becoming an object of its own awareness (Plotinus's *nous*). This creates the world of duality. The dualistic trickery of mercury, as a messenger, separates "here" from "there", "coming" from "going", and divides the absolute into "self-knowledge". This allows for the idea of limitation and form, represented by Saturn, as opposed to the unformed nature of the *primum mobile* (first mover). From the Vedic perspective, this might be Maya, the world of illusion (name, form, and function).

AM THE OBSERVED

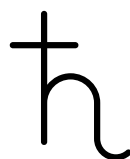
PURE CONSCIOUSNESS PM



Pure consciousness IS personal consciousness through the path of the moon. Like the moon, our personal consciousness reflects the absolute consciousness. Also like the moon, our personal consciousness/mind moves through phases and rhythms, which themselves are movements of the absolute. These rhythms mutually arise from the duality introduced by the magus. She is the subconscious answer to conscious magus. In the high priestess, we recognize there is no difference between our mind and the absolute.

AM PERSONAL CONSCIOUSNESS

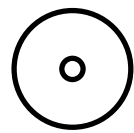
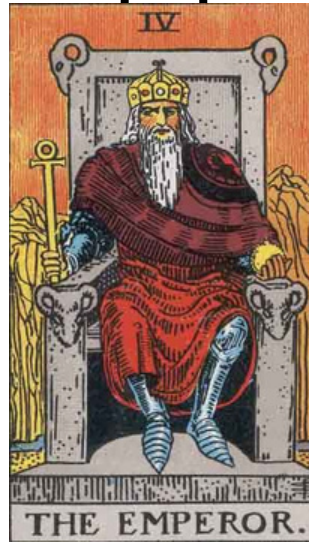
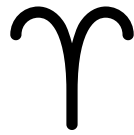
THE OBSERVER



The observer IS the observed through the path of Venus. This path has 2 meanings. First, that which is observed exists due to an observer. The "mind" vibrates the form of what it apprehends (see the Yogasutras of Patanjali). Second, the observer itself is observed through pure consciousness. The empress exemplifies the relationship of observer and observed. It follows that she is attributed to Venus, planet of love, attraction, value, and relationships.

AM THE OBSERVED

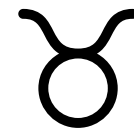
THE OBSERVER



The observer IS the personal consciousness through the path of Aries, cardinal fire. This is the creation of self illumined by the silent witness. The motto of Aries is "I am". The self is finite as opposed to the infinite Self. The "personal consciousness" can be interpreted as "mind" that arises to the observer.

AM PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS

THE OBSERVER



The observer IS/BECOMES the subjective experience through the path of Taurus, fixed earth. The difference between the two is that the observer is untouched and still while the subjective experience has variation and causality. From a non-dual perspective, the subjective experience owes its existence to the observer. The observer, becoming/appering as experience, is symbolized by Taurus, the sign of sensation. The bull is related to stories of divine conception (Pasiphae, Jesus, etc.) One might compare this to "the word made flesh".

AM THE SUBJECTIVE
EXPERIENCE

I THE OBSERVED

h

Understanding
3

♊



○

Beauty
6

AM PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS

The observed IS/BECOMES the personal consciousness through the path of Gemini, mutable air. The personal consciousness, a separate self, is a result of something *outside* of it being observed. This is the creative capacity of the absolute appearing as (Advaita Vedanta's interpretation) or emanating into (Plotinus' interpretation) multiplicity. This can be experienced in the later steps of the *Meta-Meditation*.

I THE OBSERVED

h

Understanding
3

♋



♂

Severity
5

AM THE ACTIVITY OF MY
EXPERIENCE

The observed (you) IS the activity of your experience. This activity is the path of Cancer, cardinal water, which symbolizes the commencement of life through incubation and form. The chariot separates itself from the world as a vehicle of its own activity, which can symbolize life, incarnation, and the body-mind complex. The self (the body-mind vehicle) is now (seemingly) apart but still a part of the Self. The observed pieces of the whole are rendered by their own activity.

I SUBJECTIVE
EXPERIENCE

4



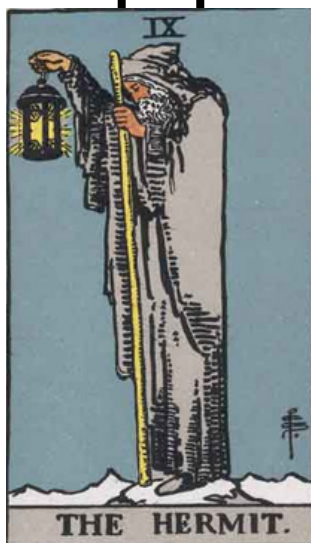
One of the most common occurrences in mystical experience is the destruction between subject and object. This can be done in various ways. Some examples include deep meditation, creative fervor, orgasm, intense devotional experiences, and so on. Strength/Lust represents the destruction of that barrier between subject and object, especially in the creative flow state where the inner and outer world work in a natural harmony. This is symbolized by Leo. Consider this and the relationship between Jupiter and Mars.

AM THE ACTIVITY OF MY
EXPERIENCE



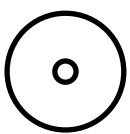
I SUBJECTIVE
EXPERIENCE

4



The subjective experience, (born from the apparent separation of subject and object, observer and observed) IS/BECOMES the personal consciousness (mind) through the path of virgo, mutable earth. Virgo represents personal growth and self-perfection. The subjective experience, symbolized by the lone hermit, becomes "mind" which illumines the world, symbolized by the sun. This is the microcosm. In Tarot Mysticism, this is not separate from the macrocosm.

AM PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS

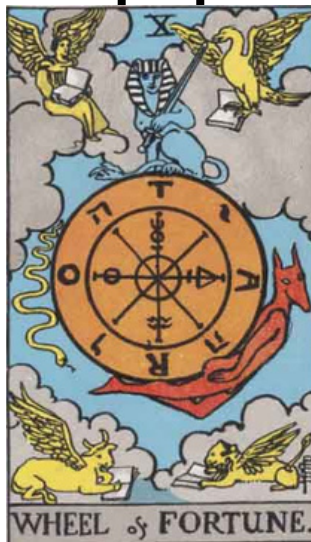


I THE SUBJECTIVE
EXPERIENCE

4



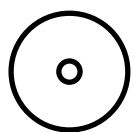
4



AM THE WILL AND
THE WHAT

The wheel of fortune provide us with a look at our subjective experience. Traditionally, this card is about external revolution, but all experience is internal. The self-perfecting goal of the hermit manifests as our subjective experience of a revolving YOUiverse in Fortune. Our subjective experience is our will and the "what" of our life. What do we want? What will we do? Jupiter is the greater benefic giving us what we want.

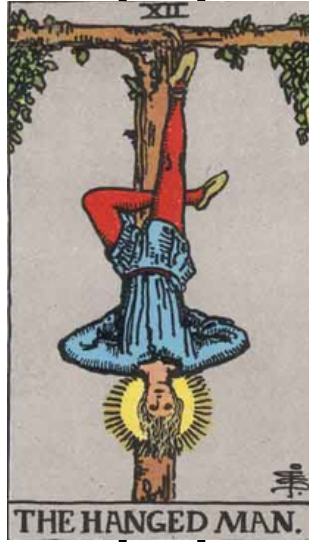
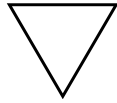
I THE ACTIVITY OF MY
EXPERIENCE



AM PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS

You (personal consciousness) are a result of your experience. Experience is a balancing act. It teaches and adjusts us. This is the constant feedback loop between outer circumstance and inner sovereignty, karma. This balanced feedback system is ruled by Libra. The "mind" and "ego" can be interpreted as the illusion of stasis (personal consciousness) arising from constant activity (balancing). Here, the mind is like the eye of a hurricane. In reality, it is only the space at the center of the rushing wind of thoughts.

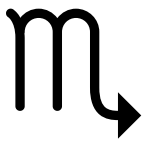
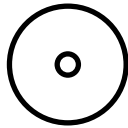
I THE ACTIVITY OF MY
EXPERIENCE



This main idea of the hanged man is that the activity of your experience is the means of this whole tarot process. In this card, we are surrendering to our own experience as a means to continue. Compare this idea to earlier cards and notice the similarity. This card corresponds to the element of water and Neptune, further suggesting its passive quality. One could say the whole tarot and mystical path to self-knowledge is surrendering to experience itself. That experience is the way and the how.

AM THE WAY AND
THE HOW

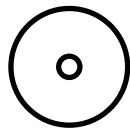
I PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS



The "will" and the "what" are objects of the individual personal consciousness, which exists through birth and death. The idea behind "will and what" is to desire something or choose something you don't already have. This is the result of the arising of personal consciousness within absolute consciousness. The personal consciousness has the illusion of lack. The result of such desire is birth and death (the authorities on this topic are the Upanishads). Scorpio is the sign of death.

AM THE WILL AND
THE WHAT

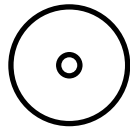
I PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS



AM AUTOMATIC

This is the first time we realize ourselves as "automatic". This is to suggest our subconscious processes. Our body-mind complexes run automatically as a result of our "will and what" and our "way and how". This card expresses the dance between personal consciousness as personal subconsciousness. The integration of opposite forces like the conscious and the subconscious is symbolized by Sagittarius and its symbols. An example is the autonomic nervous system. The idea is that all processes happens naturally, without our effort. Compare this to the Chinese idea of wu-wei. Combine this with the High Priestess and the message becomes: "absolute consciousness becomes personal consciousness which becomes me automatically".

I PERSONAL
CONSCIOUSNESS



AM THE WAY AND
THE HOW

The devil represents physical generation as the "way and the how" of personal consciousness. From a Vedantic perspective, we can look at our physical experience as an illusion that arises within consciousness. From another perspective, matter is just the projection of measurement (meter) from the mind. This expresses hod, "the way and the how", of personal consciousness: to measure. The body can be measured finitely but the awareness is infinite. Capricorn, as the mountain-climbing sea-goat, symbolizes these material endeavors of matter and meter. This card is the outpouring of personal consciousness into all means and methods of being. Procreation is the most obvious example, but it doesn't stop there.

I THE WILL AND
THE WHAT



The will (and the what) is its own method (the way and the how). This card expresses how creation is destruction. It follows that destructive Mars is attributed to the path that leads from desirous Venus to methodical and creative Hermes. This is the third horizontal path on the tree of life. Each of these three both describe a creative and destructive act simultaneously. One way to approach this card is to know that "what" is in front of us is the right "way".



AM THE WAY AND
THE HOW

I THE WILL AND
THE WHAT

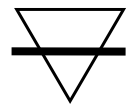


The star symbolizes the Self-generated will as the automatic processes driving us forward. This is further suggested by the Aquarius attribution, a sign of individuality, progress, and forward-thinking. As divine will, you happen automatically. The "will" and the "what" of consciousness run naturally through all of your organic processes.



AM AUTOMATIC

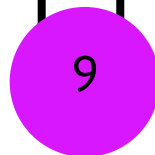
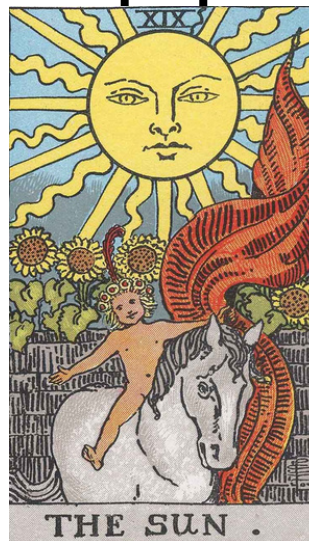
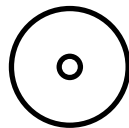
I THE WILL AND
THE WHAT



The Moon represents the will of the universe and nature to embody in every way possible. This is the developing subconscious mind throughout various past species and past lives. Pisces represents these goings-on that transcend the individual life. Consider this card alongside Plotinus' ideas on the contemplation of nature (Ennead III.8[4]).

AM EMBODIED

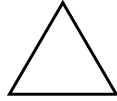
I THE WAY AND
THE HOW



The sun is used metaphorically in the same way by various mystics and philosophers (Upanishads, Plato, Plotinus, among many others) to describe the effortless way that consciousness illumines everything. In this way, Mercury, the methodology and intelligence of the universe, the logos, is automatic (the moon). The sun represents this ease.

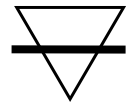
AM AUTOMATIC

I

THE WAY AND
THE HOW

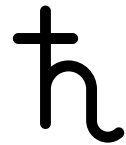
In Judgement/The Aeon, you realize your embodiment as the way and the how of consciousness/the absolute. The earth (malkuth) is illuminated (fire) by intelligent design (mercury, the logos).

AM EMBODIED



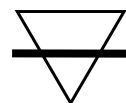
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AUTOMATIC



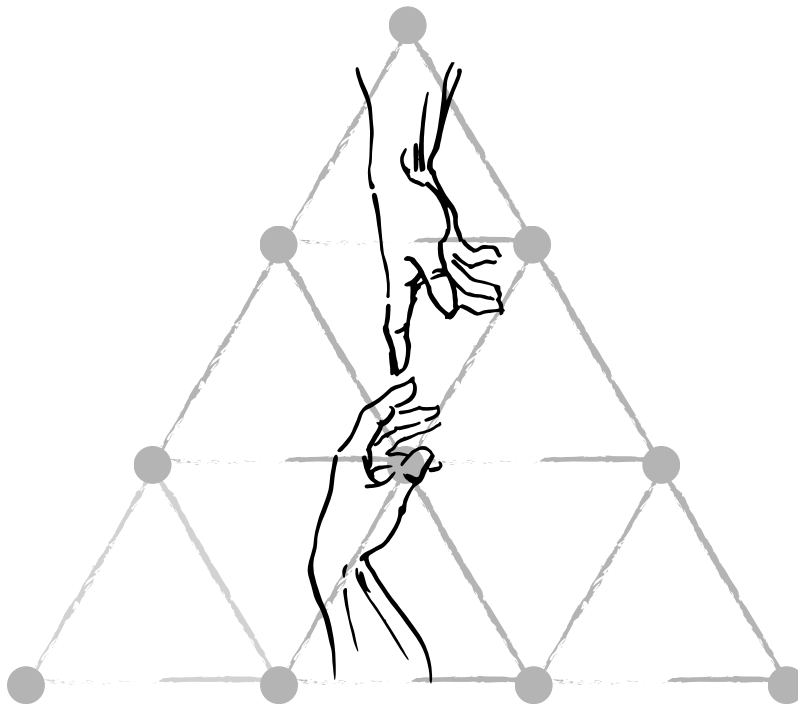
At the end, consciousness is automatically embodied. Self-knowledge is both the end of a process of creation, AND the end to the mystical quest. It is both the reward and what starts the journey. Because of this, the major arcana describe both the creation of the universe down the tree of life, and in the same order, the climb back up.

AM EMBODIED



This guide is a small portion of an
online textbook from the Tarot
Mysticism Academy.

For the full textbook, or to take the full
course, visit
www.tarotmysticismacademy.com



ABOUT JOE

Joe Monteleone, a "one-man-band of magical-thinking-made reality" (Huffington Post), is a Tarot master teacher, coach, healer, and modern mystic. He has over two decades of experience in tarot. He has read, taught, and performed tarot and mystical philosophy all around the physical and virtual worlds. After a life-changing mystical experience, he created the Tarot Mysticism Academy, where he now connects hundreds of mystical misfits all over the globe to explore the edges of reality through tarot's perennial philosophy.

